Unit 6 — Food Cultures

Track G+M · Klasse 7 · Niveau G/M

Learning objectives I

- *I can read a short narrative about a family dish and identify what makes it meaningful beyond taste.*
- *I can describe a recipe using imperatives and basic quantifiers.*
- *I can hold a 2-minute conversation about a food tradition with a partner.*

Lead-in I

Aisha's grandmother does not measure things. She measures by look, smell, and the angle of her wooden spoon. Aisha has tried to write down the recipe for the family rice three times. Each time, her grandmother has read the recipe and said, very gently, "This is wrong." When Aisha asked what was wrong, her grandmother said, "It says *one teaspoon of salt*. There is no teaspoon. There is only your hand."

Vocabulary I

- to chop
- to slice
- to peel
- to boil
- to fry
- to bake
- to season
- to taste
- to stir
- to serve

Reading I

Reading text — *The Sunday Chicken*

Anya's grandfather makes the same dish every Sunday: rice, chicken, a sauce with herbs the family will not name in English because the English name does not feel right. The dish has migrated with the family for two generations. In the village, it was made with a chicken from the yard. In the city, it is made with a chicken from the supermarket. The taste is mostly the same. Sundays are the day Anya's grandfather speaks the most. The dish, he says, is what the family is. Every other day they argue about everything. On Sundays they argue about the chicken.

Vocabulary cluster — kitchen and recipe

Reading II

Verb	Noun
to chop	a knife, a board
to slice	a slice

Verb	Noun
to peel	the peel
to boil	a pot

Reading III

Verb	Noun
to fry	a pan
to bake	an oven

Verb	Noun
to season	salt, pepper, herbs, spices
to taste	a taste

Reading IV

Verb	Noun
to stir	a spoon
to serve	a plate, a bowl

Useful phrases.

- *to be born of — that recipe is born of two villages.*
- *to pass down — the recipe was passed down from grandmother.*
- *a family staple — rice and beans is our family staple.*

Reading V

Language focus — quantifiers

Quantifier	Use	Example
some	positive sentences (definite quantity)	*We need some salt.*
any	negatives and questions	*Is there any rice left?*

Reading VI

Quantifier	Use	Example
many	countable, often negatives/questions	*There aren't many eggs.*
much	uncountable, often negatives/questions	*There isn't much milk.*

Quantifier	Use	Example
a few	small countable amount, positive	*Add a few onions.*
a little	small uncountable amount, positive	*Add a little salt.*

Reading VII

Quantifier	Use	Example
a lot of / lots of	both, positive and informal	*We have a lot of rice.*

Language focus — recipe imperatives
A recipe in English usually uses the **imperative**: base verb, no subject.

- *Chop the onion finely.*
- *Add a little oil.*
- *Don't boil the herbs for too long.*

Reading VIII

- *Let the rice rest for ten minutes.*

For polite cooking talk: *Could you pass the salt? Would you mind stirring this?*

Practise I

Niveau G — controlled
A. Some, any, much, or many?

1. Is there _____ chicken in the fridge?
2. We need _____ rice for tonight.
3. There aren't _____ tomatoes left.
4. There isn't _____ time before dinner.

Practise II

B. Match the verb to the kitchen tool.

Verb	Tool
1. to chop	a. an oven
2. to bake	b. a knife

Verb	Tool
3. to fry	c. a pot
4. to boil	d. a pan

Practise III

Niveau M — productive
C. Re-write as a polite recipe instruction.

5. You should peel the potatoes first. → ___
6. You must not add salt before boiling. → ___
7. You should let the dough rest for thirty minutes. → ___

D. Quantifier transformation. Rewrite using *a few* or *a little*.

8. We have some eggs (three). → ___

Practise IV

9. There is some salt (less than a teaspoon). → ___
10. We have some butter (about half a stick). → ___

Your turn I

Pair speaking task — *Family Plate*. With your partner, take turns describing a dish that means something in your family. For each dish, the listener asks at least one *follow-up* question (*Who taught the cook? When was the first time you ate it?*).
Three rules:

- Use at least one quantifier per turn (*a little / a few / not much*).
- Use at least one imperative inside a quoted family instruction (*"My grandmother always says, 'Don't open the oven.'"*).
- Two minutes each direction.

Your turn II

Volunteers share with the class at the end.

Reflect I

- I can read a short narrative about a family dish and explain what makes it meaningful beyond taste.
- I can use *some / any / much / many / a few / a little* correctly.
- I can give simple recipe instructions in English.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC Food — recipe pages with short instruction texts in imperative. https://www.bbc.co.uk/food
- Samin Nosrat, *Salt Fat Acid Heat* — accessible chapters; clear English. https://www.saltfatacidheat.com
- The Guardian — *Word of Mouth* food blog. https://www.theguardian.com/lifeandstyle/series/word-of-mouth